

Visual Effects Report

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Site Details

Here is the URL to my [Unit 3 visual effects page](#).

Reflection

Design Decisions

One visual effect I used was the gradient overlay on the hero image. I wanted the hero section to feel more dramatic and polished, but I also needed the text to stay readable. The gradient helped darken the image without completely hiding it, and the text shadow gave the heading more depth. At first, I considered making the image darker with only a filter, but that made the whole image feel too flat, so the overlay worked better.

Another effect I used was the card shadow and hover lift. I wanted the cards to feel clickable and separated from the background. The raised shadow on hover communicates interaction and helps the user understand that the card is an active element. I kept the shadow subtle because a stronger shadow started to feel distracting.

Dark Mode Challenges

The hardest part was making the shadows and glass effect look good in both light and dark mode. In light mode, darker shadows were easy to see, but in dark mode they could become too heavy or disappear into the background. I solved this by using shadow and background values that were subtle enough to work with both themes. I also used transparent backgrounds and `light-dark()` where needed so the glass panel still felt visible without becoming too bright or too dark.

Restraint

I considered adding more dramatic filters and stronger blend mode effects, but I decided not to because the page already had several visual effects. Too many effects made the page feel busy instead of polished. Removing the extra effects taught me that visual effects should support the content, not compete with it. The best effects are noticeable enough to improve the design, but subtle enough that the user can still focus on the information.